LANGUAGE AND STYLE

(USPS 435-710)

Editor: E. L. EPSTEIN; *Associate Editor:* DOUGLAS BUTTURFF; *European Editor:* TERENCE F. HAWKES, *University College, Cardiff, Wales; Assistant Editor:* ROBERT KOLE

ADVISORS

Robert Abernathy, Robert Austerlitz, Morton Bloomfield, J. C. Catford, Seymour Chatman, Jonathan Culler, Alvar Ellegard, Nils Erik Enkvist, Michael Gregory, Sidney Greenbaum, M. A. K. Halliday, A. A. Hill, Henry M. Hoenigswald, John Hollander, Dell Hymes, W. P. Lehmann, Samuel R. Levin, J. C. McGalliard, Angus McIntosh, Richard M. Ohmann, Randolph Quirk, Michael Riffaterre, Thomas A. Sebeok, George Y. Shevelov, John Sinclair, John Spencer, Edward Stankiewicz, Arnold Stein, Peter Strevens, Teun van Dijk, Calvert Watkins, Wiktor Weintraub, P. J. Wexler, Kenneth Wilson, Victor H. Yngve.

Language and Style is published quarterly at Queens College of the City University of New York. Subscriptions should be sent to *Language and Style,* Editorial Services, Kiely Hall 1309, Queens College, CUNY, Flushing, NY 11367-1597, USA.

Subscription rates: $16 per year for the US ($18 foreign)
$22 per year for institutions ($25 foreign)
$ 5 for single copies

Correspondence on editorial matters should be addressed to E. L. Epstein, Editor, *Language and Style,* Department of English, Queens College, CUNY, Flushing, NY 11367-1597.

Language and Style is devoted to publishing articles on style in all of its manifestations, in all of the arts, and in all of its social and cultural contexts. Articles may be in English, French, and German and may be any length from 4,000 words to 25,000 words. There are no restrictions on theoretical approaches; any consistent and well-defined system, from mathematical linguistics to traditional rhetorical analysis, may be employed. It should be possible to employ the analytical methods in each article in a general definition of style.

Manuscripts should be typed on one side of unglazed paper, double-spaced (including footnotes, quotations, and bibliography), with margins of not less than 1½ inches, and should be accompanied by a duplicate of the manuscript. References should be placed at the end of the text in alphabetical order, as well as all special materials such as diagrams, tables, charts, etc. A copy of all materials submitted should be retained by the author. All submissions must include a self-addressed, stamped envelope large enough to contain the typescript of the article.

Listed in *American Humanities Index*

Language and Style (USPS 435-710) (ISSN 0023-8317) is published four times a year for $16 ($18 foreign; $22 institutions) by the Queens College Press, Queens College, Kiely Hall 1309, Flushing, NY 11367-1597. Second-class postage paid at Flushing, NY and additional mailing offices. POSTMASTER: Send address changes to the Queens College Press, Kiely Hall 1309, Flushing, NY 11367-1597.

LANGUAGE AND STYLE

AN INTERNATIONAL JOURNAL

Volume 22, No. 3 *Summer 1989*

Contents

On Being Cooperative in Wonderland: Alice's Communicative Competence 223
HEATHER K. HARDY

On Phonetic Repetition in *Moby-Dick* 239
BRENT VINE

Between Cognition and Discourse: Language as Continuum 255
LLOYD DAVIS

Bright Eminence: Milton's Poetics and Theology as Revealed Through Character Names in *Paradise Lost* 263
LARRY RICHARD ISITT

Metrical Typology of English and Korean Verse: Iambic Hexameter and Septameter / Sijo and Kasa 307
MARINA TARLINSKAJA AND KIM MYONG-HO

The Link between Language and Social Knowledge: Speech Situations in Faulkner's *Sanctuary* 329
CAROL F. BENDER

Old English Dual Pronouns and Their Poetic Uses 337
LOIS BRAGG

Correction to Volume 22, No. 1 350

QUEENS COLLEGE PRESS
FLUSHING, NEW YORK

U.S. Postal Service

STATEMENT OF OWNERSHIP, MANAGEMENT AND CIRCULATION

Required by 39 U.S.C. 3685)

1A. Title of Publication	1B. PUBLICATION NO.	2. Date of Filing
Language & Style	4 3 5 7 1 0	11/23/92
3. Frequency of Issue	3A. No. of Issues Published Annually	3B. Annual Subscription Price
Quarterly	4	16

4. Complete Mailing Address of Known Office of Publication *(Street, City, County, State and ZIP+4 Code) (Not printers)*

Queens College Press, Queens College, Kiely 1309, Flushing, NY 11367

5. Complete Mailing Address of the Headquarters of General Business Offices of the Publisher *(Not printer)*

same as above

6. Full Names and Complete Mailing Address of Publisher, Editor, and Managing Editor *(This item MUST NOT be blank)*

Publisher *(Name and Complete Mailing Address)*

same as above

Editor *(Name and Complete Mailing Address)*

Edmund Epstein, English Dept., Queens College, Flushing, NY 11367

Managing Editor *(Name and Complete Mailing Address)*

John Cassidy, Editorial Services, Queens College, Flushing, NY 11367

7. Owner *(If owned by a corporation, its name and address must be stated and also immediately thereunder the names and addresses of stockholders owning or holding 1 percent or more of total amount of stock. If not owned by a corporation, the names and addresses of the individual owners must be given. If owned by a partnership or other unincorporated firm, its name and address, as well as that of each individual must be given. If the publication is published by a nonprofit organization, its name and address must be stated.) (Item must be completed.)*

Full Name	Complete Mailing Address
Queens College	Flushing, NY

8. Known Bondholders, Mortgagees, and Other Security Holders Owning or Holding 1 Percent or More of Total Amount of Bonds, Mortgages or Other Securities *(If there are none, so state)*

Full Name	Complete Mailing Address
None	

9. For Completion by Nonprofit Organizations Authorized To Mail at Special Rates *(DMM Section 423.12 only)*
The purpose, function, and nonprofit status of this organization and the exempt status for Federal income tax purposes *(Check one)*

(1) [X] Has Not Changed During Preceding 12 Months
(2) [ ] Has Changed During Preceding 12 Months
(If changed, publisher must submit explanation of change with this statement.)

10. Extent and Nature of Circulation *(See instructions on reverse side)*	Average No. Copies Each Issue During Preceding 12 Months	Actual No. Copies of Single Issue Published Nearest to Filing Date
A. Total No. Copies *(Net Press Run)*	900	900
B. Paid and/or Requested Circulation 1. Sales through dealers and carriers, street vendors and counter sales		
2. Mail Subscription *(Paid and/or requested)*	701	701
C. Total Paid and/or Requested Circulation *(Sum of 10B1 and 10B2)*	701	701
D. Free Distribution by Mail, Carrier or Other Means Samples, Complimentary, and Other Free Copies	80	80
E. Total Distribution *(Sum of C and D)*	781	781
F. Copies Not Distributed 1. Office use, left over, unaccounted, spoiled after printing	119	119
2. Return from News Agents		
G. TOTAL *(Sum of E, F1 and 2—should equal net press run shown in A)*	900	900

11. I certify that the statements made by me above are correct and complete

Signature and Title of Editor, Publisher, Business Manager, or Owner

John Cassidy Managing Editor

PS Form 3526, Feb *(See instructions on reverse)*

ON PHONETIC REPETITION IN *MOBY-DICK*

BRENT VINE

I

JAMES WILLIAM NECHAS'S BOOK ON REPETITION in *Moby-Dick*[1] marked the most significant advance in the study of Melville's style since Walter Weber's monograph of 1937.[2] Nechas justly criticizes the broad, impressionistic labeling that generally passes for "analysis" of Melville's style, and calls for a more rigorous and avowedly linguistic approach, including real analysis of particular examples, with supporting documentation—both sorely lacking in virtually all previous treatments (except for Weber's).[3] The major finding of Nechas's book is that "the hallmark of the language of *Moby-Dick* is semantic multiplication, a very deepseated tendency toward repetition" (34). Nechas is not the first to notice the importance of repetition as a feature of Melville's style;[4] he is the first to claim, however, that repetition is the most pervasive and fundamental organizing principle of Melville's language in *Moby-Dick*.[5]

Like most previous studies of Melville's style, Nechas's treatment is almost entirely lexical in orientation, although he freely acknowledges (51) the existence of many other kinds of repetition in *Moby-Dick* than the key words and word-types he examines. I suggest, in fact, that one of the most important forms of repetition in *Moby-Dick* is *phonetic repetition*, with alliteration perhaps its most perceptually prominent strategy. I further propose that Melville's use of alliteration (and phonetic repetition in general) involves a hitherto unsuspected correlation with certain types of vocabulary, and that this correlation illuminates broader issues regarding Melville's style.

Apart from Weber's fairly thorough survey (see especially 23-37), literary scholarship has all but neglected the phonetic texture of Melville's prose. An interesting early treatment is G. B. Munson's brief "analysis of letter values," in his *Style and Form in American Prose* (Garden City, NY: Doubleday, 1929, 147-49). Munson discusses "the harmony of vowel and consonant relation-

ships" in Melville's prose, in terms of "the effects of individual letters"; an analysis of a passage from *Mardi* reveals, among other things, "subdued" labials, "sensations of coolness and dancing . . . conveyed by the open vowels and the short vowels," a "determinative" quality imparted by "k" sounds, etc. By virtue of Munson's orthographic/phonetic confusions (not to speak of real phonetic inaccuracies), his alphabetico-phonetic descriptions are linguistically crude by modern standards; the above extracts from his *Mardi* analysis reveal, moreover, familiar excesses of traditional "sound symbolism" modes of thinking. But Munson hit upon an important feature of Melville's prose, one which clearly required the careful (if naïve) phonetic parsing Munson attempted. His concluding remarks demonstrate, in fact, an understanding of "subliminal verbal patterning" in precisely the Jakobsonian sense:

> This is not to imply that the writer consciously plots out his letters . . . but it is saying that there is no chance about the effects on the reader. For those effects there are causes, and the writer by design or instinct or chance has supplied the causes.[6]

More recently, Matsumoto has provided an anecdotal discussion of similar phonetic features, via brief analyses of several passages in terms of rhythm, alliteration, assonance, and internal rhyme.[7] But his analyses are again phonetically crude, and offered in a traditional (i.e., characteristically vague and subjective) framework of "sound symbolism."[8]

The following remarks are offered as a contribution to the formal analysis of Melville's phonetic technique. As Nechas has shown for Melville's lexical technique, our understanding of Melville's style—which has proven notoriously intractable under more traditional modes of analysis—is likely to be enhanced by the application of rigorous linguistic methodology.

II

Nechas himself pays little systematic attention to phonetic features. But the keystone of his first chapter is a detailed structural analysis of the famous first paragraph of *Moby-Dick* ("Call me Ishmael . . . with me."); here Nechas includes observations about a number of striking phonetic features, including alliterated sequences (***g**rowing **g**rim; **d**amp, **d**rizzly*) and similar non-adjacent consonantal repetitions (***s**trong moral **p**rinciple to **p**revent me from deliberately **s**tepping into the **s**treet*), internal schemes of rhyme and assonance, of varying degrees of complexity (e.g., ***p**ausing before co**ff**in warehouses, and **b**ringing*), and framing patterns (*I **a**ccount it **h**igh time to **g**et to **s**ea as **s**oon as I **c**an*), partly associated with syntactic/semantic parallelism: *With a **p**hilosophical **f**lourish, **C**ato throws **h**imself upon his **s**word; I **q**uietly take to the **s**hip*, i.e., [f . . . l . . . s]+[fl . . . ʃ], followed by parallel [k]. . . [s]/[k]. . . [ʃ] (or even, as Nechas fails to notice, [k]+[θ]. . . [s]/[k]+[t]. . . [ʃ]).[9]

It is no accident that all of these forms of phonetic patterning recur in the novel's equally remarkable final paragraph:

> 1) Now small fowls flew screaming over the yet yawning gulf; a sullen white surf beat against its steep sides; then all collapsed, and the great shroud of the sea rolled on as it rolled five thousand years ago.[10]

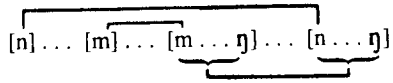
Much can be said about this paragraph, on many levels. But let me restrict my attention to its purely phonetic features, beginning with alliteration.

The paragraph—which consists of a single sentence—contains a high concentration of alliterated sequences. The first unit (up to the first semi-colon) contains the two sequences *fowls flew* and *yet yawning*, while the second unit (up to the second semi-colon) ends with the sequence *steep sides*. Note also the closely associated adjective-noun sequence *sullen* [*white*] *surf*, at the beginning of the second unit. The *positioning* of these sequences within their units is also noteworthy: much as the two noun phrases *sullen* [*white*] *surf* and *steep sides* frame the second unit, *fowls flew* and *yet yawning* are distributed, respectively, on either side of the centrally positioned participle *screaming* in the first unit. The rest of the sentence lacks alliterated sequences in the technical sense, although other forms of consonantal repetition are present, as we shall see.

In addition to strict alliteration, the passage contains a number of striking chains of repeated phonetic material. Consider, first, the following notation of the first unit, which simply highlights repeated consonantal material:

> 2) Now **small** fowls **f**lew scream**ing** over the yet yawn**ing** gu**lf**;[11]

The unit begins with the alveolar nasal [n], continues in the second word with the bilabial nasal [m], then combines [m] with the velar nasal [ŋ] in the sequence ***-ming*** of *screaming*, and concludes with the rhyming sequence ***-ning*** (of *yawning*), this time coupling the final velar nasal with the alveolar nasal [n], with which the unit began. There is, then, not only a high concentration of nasals in general,[12] but also a linear progression that shows both parallel and chiastic patterning in the articulation of nasal consonants:



Note also the prominence of [l] at the beginning of the unit, both directly before and within the first alliterated phrase (***s**mall **f**owls **f**lew*), with [lf . . . l . . . fl] echoed by the cluster [lf] at the end of the final word ***g**ulf*. The alliterated sequence *fowls flew*, moreover, is itself enclosed by alliterating *s*-items (*small* [*fowls flew*] *screaming*), each of which is grammatically associated with its adjacent alliterating *f*-item (attributive adjective + noun; verb + participle). In terms of assonance and internal rhyme, note ***now**/**fowl**s* (i.e., [aw] or [æw], *small/**yawn**ing* (i.e., [ɔ]), as well as the repeated ***-ing*** of *screa**ming**/yawn**ing*** already mentioned.

The first phrase of the second unit (*a **s**ullen white **s**urf*) strikingly recalls certain of the salient features of the first unit, as just described, namely the repeated [s] and the overall prominence of [l] and [n]; even the [l]/[f] association (cf. the remarks on *small fowls flew* and *gulf*) is obliquely picked up by the first noun ***s**urf*, assuming a liquid pronunciation for the [r], whether *ur* repre-

sents a vowel plus [r], or simply a syllabic [r] (i.e., [ɝ]).[13] But despite these reminiscences, the unit continues, as it were, in a different key, as shown by the following representation, which again highlights repeated consonantal material:

3) a sullen white surf beat against its steep sides;

The prominence of [s] and [t] in this passage is undeniable; note also the last word *sides*, whose consonants consist of [s], followed by the voiced counterparts of [t] and [s], i.e., [d] and [z]. In view of this voicing relationship, the unit's internal rhyme is particularly interesting: ***beat*** and ***steep*** not only share the same medial vowel, but show almost perfect mirror images of each other's consonantal frames (apart from the initial *s-* of *steep*, which is lacking in *beat*). Again: the [b] and [p] of ***beat/steep*** are voiced and voiceless counterparts of each other.[14]

Despite the absence of alliteration per se in the third unit, one can nevertheless point to certain conspicuous types of phonetic patterning. The liquids [r] and [l] assume some prominence, as do other continuants, which are not only frequent but markedly varied (including [s, z, f, v, θ ð, ʃ, j]):

4) **th**en **all** collapsed, and **th**e great **shr**oud of **th**e sea **r**olled on as it **r**olled five **th**ousand **y**ears ago.

Note further that *collapsed* (phonetically [kəlæpst]), with its three-member cluster [pst], recalls the preceding ***steep sides***, as *surf* recalled the preceding *gulf/fowls flew*. The noun phrase that begins the next sentence gives the closest approximation in this unit to an alliterated sequence: the noun + adj. sequence ***great shroud*** (cf. *sullen . . . surf, steep sides*) shows similarly structured two-member initial clusters [gr] and [ʃr], both with [r] as second member.[15] Note finally the repeated stressed vowels (or rather, diphthongs) in *shroud/thousand* and *rolled/rolled/ago*, which appear in an interlocking *abbab* order: *shroud/rolled/rolled/thousand/ago*. The full repetition of an entire word occurs (for the first and only time in the passage) precisely in this sequence, in which the vowel of the repeated word turns out to be the final vowel of the passage.

In addition to phonetic features defined at the segmental level, an equally striking set of features can be described in terms of accent and rhythm. The first unit begins with a series of five accented syllables (the first four being monosyllabic words), continues with a partly trochaic rhythm, and closes with another stressed monosyllable:

5) / / / / / x x x x / / x /
Now small fowls flew screaming over the yet yawning gulf;

The impression of trochaic rhythm—which in any case is slight—derives principally from the words with trochaic word-shape (*screaming, yawning*).[16] This impression would be strengthened by analyzing *over the* as a resolved trochee (/ x̂x), in view of the initial stress in *over*, as uttered in isolation. But in terms of the phonological phrase as a whole in this context, the initial stress of *over* is considerably reduced, and hence my notation in 5). According to this reading, then, the irregular sequence /x | xxx/ | /x—with clear trochees surrounding an unrelated and unresolvable fourth paeon—contributes rather to an impression of ametricality. The salient rhythmic feature is the prominence of stressed syllables, most of these being both adjacent and monosyllabic. Much the same pattern—but with a twist—appears in the second unit:

6) x / x / / / x x x / /
a sullen white surf beat against its steep sides;

After an opening amphibrach (the accentual inverse of the immediately preceding cretic rhythm at the end of the first unit), this unit continues with three successive stressed monosyllables, and ends with two stressed monosyllables, surrounding a sequence of three unstressed syllables, very much as in 5). Here, however, the line's basically ametrical character is related to a latent *iambic* element, introduced primarily by the iambic phrase *its steep*, supported by the preceding word *against*, which has an iambic stress-pattern in isolation.[17] (In extraordinarily effective fashion, moreover, the opening amphibrach—which by definition incorporates both iambic and trochaic elements—mediates between the preceding trochaic rhythm and the subsequent iambic rhythm.)

The third unit is quite different in structure. Its contrast (as also its close relationship) with the preceding two units is signaled most obviously by its length: it is almost exactly equal to the length of the first two units combined.[18] The sequences of stressed monosyllables so characteristic of the first two units do not recur, the only such sequence appearing in the figure with "imperfect alliteration" (*great shroud*) discussed above. The intervening unstressed syllables, in fact, give a decidedly iambic rhythm; the unit divides naturally into two relatively unexceptionable iambic pentameter lines:

7) x / x / x x / / x x /
then all collapsed, and the great shroud of the sea

/ / x x / /s / x / x /
rolled on as it rolled five thousand years ago.[19]

Note, finally, that the marked rhythmic contrast between 5) and 6) on the one hand, and 7), on the other, provides an example of Melville's iconic use of phonetic (and here specifically rhythmic) patterning: the clipped, irregular rhythm of the first two units, with their characteristic sequences of stressed monosyllables, provides a perceptual phonetic parallel to the essentially static image of the birds hovering over the "yet yawning gulf" (note the element of extension in time imparted by the *yet*), and of the beating surf; in direct contrast, the driving iambic rhythm of the third unit correlates with the dynamic scene of collapse and primeval motion it describes. In a similar way, the repetition of the verb *rolled* itself is iconic of the repetitive motion it describes.[20]

III

In spite of Leonard Woolf's pronouncement that Melville "bespatters his

sentences with semi-colons without regard to meaning or convention,"[21] the discrete (and yet interrelated) rhythmic and phonetic structures outlined above show that Melville's organization of this sentence via semi-colons was quite exact. But the sentence that drew Woolf's fire (perhaps justifiably) was the following:

> 8) That certain sultanism of his brain, which had otherwise in a good degree remained unmanifested; through those forms that sultanism became incarnate in an irresistible dictatorship. [22]

Woolf comments: "This is a thoroughly bad sentence, and its badness is quite pointless, and there are thousands like it in *Mardi* and *Moby-Dick*." There is, to be sure, some truth in each of these three charges. But my aim is not to confirm or deny these accusations, but rather to describe, in formal terms, one of the salient features of the sentence (and "thousands like it").

Not counting repeated words (the indefinite article *a/an*, the demonstrative *that*, the preposition *in*), the sentence contains twenty-two different words. Consider the sources of these words in terms of the etymological dichotomy fundamental to English vocabulary: inherited Germanic items versus imported (mostly Latin-based) derivatives.[23] The individual words break down as follows: there are thirteen inherited Germanic items (*that, of, his, brain, which, had, otherwise, in, a, good, through, those, became*), or about 59% of the sentence; eight Latin-based items (*certain, degree, remained, unmanifested, forms, incarnate, irresistible, dictatorship*), or about 36% of the sentence; and a single word that is ultimately of Semitic origin (*sultanism*), accounting for the remaining 4% of the sentence.[24] But a meaningful analysis of the relative weight of these items should take into account the fact that virtually all of the "structure-words" of English are of Germanic origin, which in this sentence accounts for the indefinite article, the demonstrative *that*, the possessive pronoun *his*, the relative pronoun *which*, the preposition *in*, the auxiliary *had*, and the adverb *otherwise*. This leaves as a residue the five nouns, five adjectives and two verbs categorized below:

9)

	Latin-Based	*Germanic*
nouns:	degree	brain
	forms	
	dictatorship	
adjs.:	certain	good
	unmanifested	
	incarnate	
	irresistible	
verb:	remained	became

	Semitic
noun:	sultanism

Thus fully nine of these twelve items (75%) are non-Germanic in origin, a ratio that accurately reflects the overwhelming proportion of such items in English vocabulary as a whole. These non-Germanic items, moreover, show features that are typical of such English vocabulary (and that distinguish it from most "native" vocabulary): they are for the most part polysyllabic; they are morphologically complex; and they are originally appropriate to semantic fields (religion, philosophy, politics, etc.) where much of the terminology falls outside the sphere of "basic vocabulary," and is thus likely to have been imported from non-Germanic sources during the times when English was particularly susceptible to such influences, for well-known historical reasons. Quite apart from any syntactic features contributing to the "badness" of this sentence, we may at least conclude that part of its typicality for Melville (and for many other nineteenth-century authors) consists in the relatively heavy Latinate component in its vocabulary.

Consider now, in the same terms, the *Moby-Dick* passage with which we began. It is evident that its etymological make-up is entirely different from that of 8). If we again eliminate basic structural items (articles, prepositions, conjunctions, etc.), the remaining nouns, adjectives, and verbs fall into the following categories:

10)

	Latin-Based	*Germanic*
nouns:	gulf	fowls
		sides
		all
		shroud
		sea
		years
adjs.:	sullen	small
		yawning
		white
		steep
		great
		five
		thousand
verbs:	collapsed	flew
	rolled	screaming
		beat

	Unknown
noun:	surf[25]

The percentages are almost exactly reversed: here only five words are non-Germanic in origin, beside sixteen Germanic items, representing 76% of the nouns, adjectives, and verbs in the passage. If we add the articles, prepositions, etc., we find that the percentage of Germanic-based vocabulary in this passage rises to a remarkably high 85%. Moreover, at least three of the five non-Germanic items show none of the typical features of Latinate vocabulary men-

tioned above; for this reason, their status as derivatives is not nearly as transparent as in words like *incarnate* or *irresistible* (in 8) above), so that they could easily be mistaken for native Germanic words: thus *surf, gulf,* and *rolled* are all monosyllabic; to the casual reader, the first two might well appear to be Germanic nautically oriented terms (like *sea, shore, stream, flood,* etc.), while *roll* looks for all the world like a basic Germanic verb (cf. *toll, poll, fill, sell, knell,* etc.), despite its Latin origin.[26] The etymological source of *sullen*—a word also easily taken for a native adjective (cf. *sulky, sultry*)—is no less opaque: the presumed Norman French source *solein* is itself unattested, to say nothing of the semantic distance between English *sullen* and Old French *seul, sol* (Modern French *seul*), or its Latin source *solus* 'single, alone.' In this sense, then, these words *function* in this passage as if they were native Germanic words, comparable in their resonance to those so designated in 10).

Not surprisingly, the only word whose non-Germanic (in this case Latin) origin is more or less transparent is *collapsed*: this is the pivotal word of the passage both semantically and in terms of its position in the sentence's rhythmic structure. (In addition to the remarks on rhythm offered above, note the pause—in effect a caesura—following this word, which is accentuated by the subsequent anapestic departure from the opening two iambs in *then all collapsed.*)

IV

The parallel analyses just presented suggest that an important feature of Melville's style consists in such marked contrasts between primarily Latinate and primarily Germanic vocabulary. This tension and interplay on the level of vocabulary, moreover, may help account for critics' traditional ambivalence in their impressionistic assessments of Melville's style. Those who, like Woolf, castigate Melville for his "bombast" or his "rant or rhetoric," may be reacting, at least partly, to the extreme Latinate element (together with certain Gothic quirks of syntax, and other features beyond the scope of this essay), especially as it surfaces in "bad" sentences like 8); whereas those who—also like Woolf—feel that *Moby-Dick* "suffers a sea-change into something rich and strange" and seems "at a certain moment to be lifted on to a higher plane of fantastic grandeur and poetry"[27] may be responding not only to the power and beauty of deceptively simple Germanic-based passages like 1), but to the subtle play of the contrast between the two styles. At the very least, we are now forced to admit that Melville's prose (at least in *Moby-Dick*) cannot meaningfully be discussed in terms of a single, monolithic style. This is the fundamental error not only of the pre-"Melville Revival" critics, but also of Lutwack's more recent study.[28] Lutwack sees variety in Melville's style only in diachronic terms, claiming that Melville "passed through at least three phases of prose style: the plain, the ornate, and the reflective." *Moby-Dick*, which falls within Melville's "ornate" period, shows a style that is essentially "declamatory" and "oratorical": it is "an epic in oratorical prose."

A far more perceptive analysis of Melville's style is due to Richard Chase,[29] who describes (in purely impressionistic terms) three *synchronically*

distinct styles in *Moby-Dick*: "the style of fact, the style of oratorical celebration of fact, the style of meditation moving toward mysticism."[30] To judge from Chase's illustrative passages, it is clear that of these three styles, the first and third involve a heavy Germanic component in their vocabulary, while the second is just as heavily Latinate, as one might expect. The third, "meditative style," which often, according to Chase, rises to heights of "poignant lyricism" generally not characteristic of the unmarked factual style, shows a further correlation with precisely the same techniques of phonetic repetition and rhythmic organization that emerged in the analysis of 1) above. One of Chase's prime examples of this style consists of the first two paragraphs of Chapter 111 ("The Pacific"):

> 11) When gliding by the Bashee isles we emerged at last upon the great South Sea; were it not for other things, I could have greeted my dear Pacific with uncounted thanks, for now the long supplication of my youth was answered; that serene ocean rolled eastwards from me a thousand leagues of blue.
>
> There is, one knows not what sweet mystery about this sea, whose gently awful stirrings seem to speak of some hidden soul beneath; like those fabled undulations of the Ephesian sod over the buried Evangelist St. John. And meet it is, that over these sea-pastures, wide-rolling watery prairies and Potters' Fields of all four continents, the waves should rise and fall, and ebb and flow unceasingly; for here, millions of mixed shades and shadows, drowned dreams, somnambulisms, reveries; all that we call lives and souls, lie dreaming, dreaming, still; tossing like slumberers in their beds; the ever-rolling waves but made so by their restlessness.

Without undertaking a full-scale analysis of this extraordinary passage, one may note the following points: the collocation *rolled . . . thousand . . . wide-rolling . . . ever-rolling* (cf. *rolled . . . rolled . . . thousand* in 1)); the sections with intensive alliteration and other forms of phonetic repetition (***wide-rolling watery prairies and Potters' Fields of all four continents; millions of mixed shades and shadows, drowned dreams***); the regular iambic rhythm of the first half of the second paragraph, culminating in the phrase *the waves should rise and fall, and ebb and flow unceasingly*, which is full of iconic effects (including the pause introduced by the comma);[31] and the diminishing syllable-structure (coupled with the repeated, hypnotic *dreaming*) of *lie dreaming, dreaming, still* (fully as effective in its iconic suggestion of somnolence as Virgil's famous, and very similar, *suadentque cadentia sidera somnos*, *Aeneid* 4.81).

This "meditative" style of 11), then, shows the same formal criteria described for 1): intensive alliteration/phonetic repetition and subtle effects of rhythm and verbal repetition, couched primarily in Germanic (or "Germanic-like," as discussed above) vocabulary.[32] It would not be excessive to claim that in passages like 1) and 11), Melville's correlation of these features has the remarkable effect of recreating the texture of ancient Germanic poetry, with its intricate prosodic structure and its dependence on alliteration as its primary constitutive feature.[33]

We can catch a provocative glimpse into Melville's creative process in this regard by examining his reworking of the original rhymed version of Psalm

18, the actual hymn that lies behind the hymn preceding Father Mapple's sermon (Chapter 9, "The Sermon").[34] Consider the second stanza of this hymn, and Melville's revision of it:

12)

Psalm 18 (1st Part), stanza 2	*Melville*
Death, and the terrors of the grave, Spread over me their dismal shade; While floods of high temptations rose, And made my sinking soul afraid.	The ribs and terrors in the whale, Arched over me a dismal gloom, While all God's sun-lit waves rolled by, And lift me deepening down to doom.

As Battenfield observes, Melville has extensively rewritten this stanza so as to match Jonah's situation. But one of the most striking retouches is Melville's extension of the two-member alliterative phrase *sinking soul*, in the last line of the original, to the three-member phrase ***deepening down to doom***, consisting (like *sinking soul*) entirely of Germanic vocabulary.[35] Melville's new alliterative phrase is also markedly enhanced by the vowel sequence [i] (***deepening***) → [a] (or [æ], the first element of the diphthong in *down*) → [u] (***doom***). These vowels traverse the farthest extremes of vowel space in English, in a front-to-back progression: highest front → lowest central (or lowest front, if [æ]) → highest back. Almost simultaneously, the sequence of word-final nasal consonants [ŋ] → [n] → [m] proceeds in the opposite direction, from back to front, this time covering the articulatory extremes of English consonants (glottal stop excluded): velar → alveolar → bilabial. These linear progressions from one phonetic extreme to another (of which the sequence of stressed vowels is perceptually more prominent) iconically suggest (and therefore accentuate) the image of vertical descent from top to absolute bottom implied in *deepening down to doom*.

It remains to define the range of Melville's alliterative (and general phonetic) technique more precisely. Despite the superficial resemblance in tone of passages 1) and 11), it would be wrong to think that the "Germanic/alliterative" style is restricted to "meditative" sections (much less those showing "meditation moving toward mysticism," in Chase's appropriately alliterative phrase.) A very different conception emerges if we consider the relation of passage 1)—the last paragraph of text before the Epilogue—to the preceding narrative.

What precedes this final paragraph is the frenzied description of Ahab's last chase of the whale. It has not, to my knowledge, been noticed that this entire scene is a verbal frenzy of alliterative and repetitive effects (including frequent repetition of whole words and phrases). Although this feature characterizes much of the last chapter, it will suffice to examine the four or five final pages of text. The most prominent alliterative/repetitive figures are the following:[36]

13) [*At length. . .*] . . . ran ringing . . . **Wh**ite **Wh**ale's . . . **m**ountain **m**ist . . . body arched **b**ack, and **b**oth . . . lengthwise high-lifted . . . *fierce* iron, and his far *fiercer curse* . . . steel and *curse* sank to the so**c**ket, as if su**c**ked . . .[37]

14) [*Almost simultaneously* . . .] . . . **Wh**ite **Wh**ale . . . take new turns . . . commanded the crew . . .[38]

15) [*What breaks* . . .] . . . Some sinew . . . *oars! oars!* . . .[39]

16) [*Hearing the tremendous* . . .] . . . **wh**ale **wh**eeled . . . **s**eemingly **s**eeing in it the source . . . fiery showers of foam.[40]

17) [*Ahab staggered*;] Ahab staggered; his hand smote . . .[41]

18) [*Oars! oars!*] *Oars! oars!* Slope downwards to thy depths, O sea . . . *last, last . . . the ship! the ship!* . . . my *ship?*

19) [*But as the oarsmen* . . .] . . . sledge-hammering seas . . . the **b**efore whale-smitten **b**ow-ends of two planks **b**urst . . . lay nearly level . . .

20) [*Meantime, . . .*] . . . **st**reamed itself **st**raight . . . forward-flowing . . . Starbuck and **St**ubb, **st**anding . . .

21) [*The whale, . . .*] *The whale, the whale! Up helm, up helm!* . . . Starbuck die, if die he must . . . fainting fit . . . *the jaw! the jaw!* . . . Oh, *Ahab, Ahab* . . . *Steady*! helmsman, *steady. Nay, nay!* . . .

22) [*Stand not* . . .] *Stand* not by *me*, but *stand* under *me* . . .[42] help *Stubb*; for *Stubb*, too, sticks . . . *I grin at thee, thou grinning whale! . . . I grin at thee, thou grinning whale*! . . . *Oh, oh! oh, oh! thou grinning whale* . . . die in his drawers . . . **m**ost **m**ouldy . . . *cherries! cherries! cherries!* . . . *cherry* . . .[43]

23) [*From the ship's* . . .] . . . side to side strangely . . . **b**road **b**and . . . **m**ortal **m**an . . . buttress of his forehead smote the **sh**ip's starboard **b**ow . . .[44] **f**ell **f**lat upon their faces . . . heads of the **h**arpooneers . . .

24) ["*The ship!* . . . "] . . . "*The hearse! — the* second *hearse!*"

25) [*Diving beneath* . . .] . . . settling **sh**ip . . . **q**uivering along its **k**eel . . . swiftly **sh**ot to the surface . . .[45]

26) ["*I turn* . . . "] . . . **h**ear thy **h**ammer . . . **u**nsurrendered spires . . . **u**ncra**c**ked **k**eel . . . **h**aughty **h**elm . . . Pole-pointed **pr**ow . . . *lonely* death on *lonely* life . . . *topmost* **gr**eatness lies in my *topmost* **gr**ief. *Ho, ho!* . . . **b**old **b**illows . . . **h**ell's **h**eart . . .[46]

27) [*The harpoon* . . .] . . . flew forward . . .[47] *ran* **th**rough the **gr**oove; *ran* foul . . . to *clear it;* he did *clear it* . . . **f**inal end **f**lew . . . smiting the sea, disappeared in its depths . . .[48]

28) [*For an instant* . . .] For an instant, the tran**c**ed[49] boat's crew **st**ood **st**ill . . . "*The ship*? Great God, where is *the ship*?" . . fading **ph**antom . . . *Fata*

Morgana . . . fixed by in*fat*uation, or fidelity, or fate . . . perches, the pagan harpooneers still maintained their sinking lookouts on the sea. And now, concentric circles seized . . . *animate* and in*animate* . . . *round* and *round* . . . smallest chip of the Pequod out of sight.[50]

29) [*But as the last* . . .] . . . hammer hovered . . . flag *faster* and yet *faster* to the *sub*siding spar . . . *sub*merged savage . . . form folded in the flag . . . hell . . . heaven . . . *her* . . . helmeted *her*self . . . [51]

The sheer mass of these ninety-odd alliterated or repeated figures in the final few pages of text lends an extraordinary cumulative effect. Equally striking is the specific fact that more than 35% of these figures involve one of the two phonemes [s] (including the cluster [st]) or [f], a distribution that cannot result from chance or sampling error. It is also significant that, for the most part, the alliterated material involves Germanic vocabulary (or etymologically opaque vocabulary, in the terms discussed above); there is only a single transparently Latinate sequence, which, interestingly, is one of those based on [f]: *fixed by infatuation, or fidelity, or fate* (preceded by *fading* ***ph****antom* and ***F****ata* ***M****organa;* see 27) above).[52]

In light of these data, consider once more the final paragraph, which I reproduce here for convenience:

29) Now small fowls flew screaming over the yet yawning gulf; a sullen white surf beat against its steep sides; then all collapsed, and the great shroud of the sea rolled on as it rolled five thousand years ago.

This orchestration of alliterative [s] and [f] sequences, the purposeful repetition of *rolled*, the closing pattern of internal rhyme and assonance—all of this forms the natural coda to the alliterative excitement of the final chase. One feels that an almost cathartic transformation takes place, as the same stylistic features that electrified the tumult of the chase here subside, as if disembodied, into a cessation of all human activity, leaving only the cries of birds, the pounding surf, and finally the immemorial roll of the sea.

If, as Lewis Mumford claims, "*Moby-Dick* is a poetic epic,"[53] it is partly, in passages like those discussed above, Melville's recreation of a Germanic alliterative epic, as rich as its ancient (and doubtless subconscious) models in its variety of moods and tones, but informed throughout by a consistent phonetic technique. I have tried to suggest something of the nature and structure of this neglected side of Melville's poetic gift.

PRINCETON UNIVERSITY

1. *Synonymy, Repetition and Restatement in the Vocabulary of Herman Melville's* Moby-Dick (Norwood, PA: Norwood Press, 1978).

2. *Herman Melville: eine stilistische Untersuchung* (Basel: Philographischer Verlag, 1937).

3. Nechas, to my knowledge, is the first American scholar to acknowledge the importance (and, apart from several of the standard Melville bibliographies, even the existence) of Weber's fundamental treatment. (To cite just one conspicuous omission: there is no mention of Weber's work in the *Literary History of the United States: Bibliography*, ed. Robert E. Spiller, et al. [New York: Macmillan, 1963], or its supplement volume [1972].) On the history of Melville style studies, see Nechas's critical survey, pp 4ff., including comments on Weber, 14-15.

4. Note, for example, Richard Bridgman's analysis of a scene from *Moby-Dick* in terms of Melville's "organization by repetition" (*The Colloquial Style in America* [New York: Oxford UP, 1966], 70-72), and Jane Tompkins, *Studies in Melville's Prose Style* (Yale Univ. dissertation, 1967), passim; note also Leonard Lutwack's observations on "repetitive syntax," in his otherwise unsatisfactory characterization of Melville's style, to which I return briefly below ("Melville's Struggle with Style," *Forum* [University of Houston quarterly], 3 [1962], 11-17); still earlier, note Nathalia Wright's discussion of various forms of repetition in her chapter on "Style" in *Melville's Use of the Bible* (Durham, NC: Duke UP, 1949), 137-72, to say nothing of Weber's extended treatment of various repetitive devices, pp. 87ff.

5. The various psychological meanings or artistic effects Nechas repeatedly imputes to particular repetitions, or to repetition in general, are far less convincing; see notes 8 and 20 below.

6. See Roman Jakobson, "Subliminal Verbal Patterning in Poetry," in *Studies in General and Oriental Linguistics, presented to Shirô Hattori* (Tokyo, 1970), 302-08; reprinted in Jakobson's *Selected Writings III: Poetry of Grammar and Grammar of Poetry* (The Hague-Paris-New York: Mouton, 1981), 136-47.

7. Masaji Matsumoto, "The Style of *Moby-Dick*," *Anglica*, 4 (1961), 33-58 (esp. 39-41).

8. On properly validated linguistic approaches to the problem of sound symbolism, see the comments (and references) in my review of Raymond Chapman's *The Treatment of Sounds in Language and Literature* (Oxford: Basil Blackwell, 1984), in *Language*, 61 (1985), 934.

9. See especially Nechas, 42, 45-47. (For the parallel behavior of [s] and [š], see note 15 below.) Unfortunately, Nechas's phonetic transcriptions are riddled with inaccuracies: he writes [ə] for both schwa and the mid back rounded [ɔ] (note, e.g., [kəʊflɪn], 45), and overlooks some vowel reductions (as in [partlkjʊlar] for *particular*, 42, or [flʊsaflkʊl], 47); even if these last two transcriptions are pardoned as phonemic representations, there is no (synchronic) linguistic level at which the *s* of *pausing* is voiceless (cf. his [pəʊsɪŋ], 45).

10. This is the final paragraph of Chapter 135 ("The Chase—Third Day"), directly preceding the Epilogue. For this paragraph, there are no differences of any kind between the original American and English editions of the text; for all quotations from *Moby-Dick*, I follow Harold Beaver's version of the American edition (Herman Melville, *Moby-Dick; or, The Whale*, ed. Harold Beaver; Middlesex: Penguin, 1972). On the textual history of *Moby-Dick*, see Beaver's introduction, 43-49; see also his tables (49-60), which record his deviations from both the original American text, and from the widely used Norton critical edition of *Moby-Dick* (ed. Harrison Hayford and Hershel Parker; New York: Norton, 1967).

11. See below for repetitions involving vowels and diphthongs. In this and all subsequent examples, the reader should interpret the boldface indications in purely phonetic terms, disregarding orthography. Thus the orthographic *ll* of *small* represents the same [l] as in *fowls* or *flew*; the orthographic *s* in *fowls* is not highlighted, since it reflects phonetic [z], versus the voiceless [s] of *small* and *screaming*; the orthographic sequence *ng* represents the velar nasal [ŋ], a phoneme related (but not identical) to the voiced velar stop in *gulf*; etc.

12. For the statistical methodology underlying such statements in the analysis of phonetic texture, see my (with Olga T. Yokoyama) "Consonantal Texture in the *Slovo o polku Igoreve*: A Quantitative Analysis," in *American Contributions to the Tenth International Congress of Slavists*, ed. Jane Gary Harris (Columbus, OH: Slavica, 1988), 415-33.

13. This last comparison of *gulf* and *surf* is of course weakened if one assumes an *r*-less pronunciation of *surf* (cf. the earlier form *suff*), as in British Received Pronunciation. The orthographic similarity, in any case, remains.

14. Note that in context, the [t] of *beat* is unreleased (and possibly flapped, depending on speed of utterance), which makes it acoustically and perceptually similar to the unaspirated [t] of *steep*. I leave aside the internal diphthongs in *white* and *sides*, which rhyme in some American dialects (but probably not in Melville's), as in Canadian English generally.

15. Here again, the final consonants of *great* and *shroud* contrast only in voicing, a contrast partially neutralized by the unreleased character of the final [t] of *great*. On the association of [s] and [š] in ***sh****roud of the sea*, cf. the example of *filosophical flouri****sh*** */sword* . . . ***ship*** discussed above (from the first paragraph of the novel): Melville systematically associates these two

phonemes; see also examples 16), 23), and 25) below.

16. The rhyming *now/fowls* at the first and third syllables also contribute to a sensation of trochaic patterning.

17. Alternatively, the second syllable of *against* could be taken to have secondary stress, or even primary stress (as often, for example, in Shakespeare); such a reading would simply heighten the iambic element in this essentially ametrical sequence. (Compare the remarks on *over* in 5) above.)

18. It is exactly equal in terms of number of words (10; 9; 19), and nearly equal in terms of number of syllables (13; 11; 24).

19. In the second line, the first *rolled* and *five* might be described more precisely as having secondary stress. For *ròlled ón*, cf. *plày ón* (*Twelfth Night* I.i.1), *lày ón* (*Macbeth* V.viii.33), *speàk ón* (*King John* II.i.422), etc. With Melville's *ròlled ón ẗas ẗt ról̀led five thóus̀and yéars ẗagó*, compare the remarkable parallel *For he hath been five thousand year a boy* (*Love's Labour's Lost* V.ii.11), in which Shakespeare's phrase *five thousand year* occupies the same metrical position I claim for Melville's *five thousand years*, and in which *five thousand year* has precisely the same biblical reference as in Melville.

20. Note that these remarks on iconic patterning rest on explicit (and therefore testable) assumptions about the acoustic or perceptual relation between sounds and their referents, in accordance with much recent work on "sound symbolism" (cf. note 8 above), and in contrast to the practice of Nechas and others (including Weber) who seek to interpret Melville's phonetic effects. (For further examples of Melville's iconic use of phonetic patterning, see Weber's phonetic analysis, p 23ff.)

21. In *The Nation & The Athenaeum*, 33 (September 1, 1923), 688; reprinted in Hayford and Parker, 629-31.

22. *Moby-Dick*, Chapter 33 ("The Specksynder"), next-to-last paragraph.

23. The term "Latin-based derivative" includes both the thousands of French borrowings dating from the Middle English period, and the (mostly later) direct importations from Latin.

24. I here leave out of account the various prefixes and suffixes (mostly productive) some of these words contain: e.g., *sultanism* with a very productive Greek suffix, *dictatorship* with a fairly productive Germanic suffix, etc.

25. Some notes on individual items: *scream* is an early borrowing from Old Norse (the remaining "Germanic" items are all native English words); *gulf* is originally from Greek κόλπος 'bosom, fold, bay,' which passed through Latin, Old Italian, and Old French before reaching Middle English; *surf* has no known etymology.

26. Lat. *rota* 'wheel' > (dimin.) *rotula* > Vulgar Lat. (unattested) *rotulare*> OFr. *roller, roler* > ME *rollen, rolen*.

27. Above, note 21 (also Hayford and Parker, 630-31).

28. Above, note 4; see especially 13-15 for his treatment of *Moby-Dick*.

29. *Herman Melville: A Critical Study* (New York: Macmillan, 1949), 87-94, 152-53.

30. Chase's thesis that the oratorical style derives from the influence of American popular rhetoric (contra Lutwack, Weber, and many others, who see literary influence primarily from Carlyle and Sir Thomas Browne) need not concern us here.

31. See Weber, 16-20, for an insightful discussion of iambic rhythm in Melville, with further examples. There are a number of other striking rhythmic touches in the passage, as in *tossing like slumberers in their beds*, in which the two dactyls (*tossing like slumberers*) literally "toss" themselves backwards into their mirror image, an anapest (*in their beds*).

32. Here again, as with *collapsed* in 1), patently Latin-based words punctuate the primarily Germanic fabric of the second paragraph at key points and with expressive items: *fabled undulations, unceasingly, somnambulisms*.

33. For a somewhat more mundane instance of the perpetuation of Old Germanic alliterative/phonetic technique in modern guise, see Knud Lambrecht's comments on German "binomial" expressions like *Mann und Maus, Land und Leute, Biegen und Brechen, Nacht und Nebel, Wind und Wetter, Rat und Tat, Lug und Trug*, etc. ("Formulaicity, Frame Semantics, and Pragmatics in German Binomial Expressions," *Language*, 60 [1984], 753-96). It is also worth noting that among classical authors, the style of Apuleius is remarkably similar to Melville's in a number of respects; on complex patterns of alliteration and phonetic repetition in Apuleius, see *Apulei Apologia*, ed. H. E. Butler and A. S. Owen (Oxford: Oxford UP, 1914), liv-lv.

34. See David B. Battenfield's discovery of this source, "The Source for the Hymn in *Moby-Dick*," *American Literature*, 27 (1955), 393-96 (reprinted in Hayford and Parker, 607-10).

35. Battenfield himself remarks that "the rhyme change may be only for assonance and the alliteration in the last line." For the alliteration on *d-*, note also the hymn's official subtitle "Deliverance from Despair."

36. The following numbered examples correspond to paragraphs, which appear here in the sequence in which they occur in the text; the initial bracket identifies each paragraph by giving its first few words. Alliterated or repeated phonetic material appears in boldface (as above), while repeated words or phrases are given in italics. See the notes appended to many of these paragraphs for discussion of additional repeated phonetic features.

37. ***Mountain mist*** is preceded by the word *smoky*; there is thus a more complex sequence involving both [s] and [m]: ***smoky mountain mist***. The long sequence with repeated [s] (. . . *steel and curse sank to the socket, as if sucked* . . .) continues throughout the rest of the sentence: . . . *into a morass, Moby-Dick sideways writhed; spasmodically . . . staving . . . so suddenly . . . tossed into the sea.*

38. Note the repetitions of [s] and [t], as well as the adjacent *un-/in-*, in the first sentence: *Almost simultaneously, with a mighty volition of* ***un****graduated,* ***in****stantaneous swiftness*. . . .

39. Commentators have long recognized the Shakespearean cast of Ahab's speech habits and decried his overblown, rhetorical style, without specifying that the most characteristic feature of his speech—almost a verbal tic—involves the repetition of words and phrases, generally with syntactic parallelism; cf. 26) below (and Ahab's first extended soliloquies, Chapters 36 and 37).

40. Note *rush of the sea-crashing boat* in the first sentence, cf. ***sh****owers* in the last sentence of the paragraph. (On [s]/[š], see note 15 above.)

41. Here *smote* (at the beginning of the paragraph) is part of an anadiplosis: the preceding paragraph ends: ". . . *smiting* his jaws amid fiery showers of foam."

42. Anadiplosis again: the preceding paragraph ends "My God, stand by me now!"

43. Note the sevenfold repetition of the name *Stubb* in this paragraph, with four other instances of initial [st-] interspersed: *Stand . . . stand . . . Stubb . . . Stubb . . . sticks . . . Stubb . . . Stubb . . . Stubb . . . stuffed . . . Stubb . . .*

44. . . . *his forehead smote:* cf. *smote* in 17) above, of which the direct object is *his forehead*.

45. I.e., [s]/[š] . . . [k] . . . [k] . . . [s]/[š]; on the collocation of [s] and [š], see note 15 above.

46. Note Ahab's characteristic repetitions of *thee* (and *thou*) in this paragraph, with syntactic parallelism: "Towards *thee* I roll, *thou* all-destroying but unconquering whale; to the last I grapple with *thee*; from hell's heart I stab at *thee*; for hate's sake I spit my last breath at *thee* . . . while still chasing *thee*, though tied to *thee, thou* damned whale!" The repeated fricative [ð] of ***thee*** and ***thou*** climaxes in Ahab's very next word, accompanying his final (and fatal) thrust: "***Thus***, I give up the spear!" (italics Melville's). Note also the internal rhyme (and initial [h]) in *hate's sake*, parallel to the alliterated ***hell's heart***.

47. Cf. *forward-flowing* in 20) above.

48. In addition to *through the groove*, note also *crew knew* in this paragraph; in addition to *flew* (2x), note also *flying* in this paragraph.

49. I.e., [trænst].

50. Here also *uppermost masts*.

51. Note also the phrase ***etherial thrill***, and the rhyme in *whole captive form folded*. The phrases *subsiding spar* and *submerged savage* in 29) do not exhaust the repetitive force of [s] (and [š] and [st]) in this paragraph: the sentence of which *submerged savage* is the subject begins "and simultaneously . . . ;" note further the "sky-hawk . . . from its natural home among the stars . . . with archangelic shrieks . . . went down with his ship, which, like Satan, would not sink to hell till she had dragged . . . and helmeted herself . . . "

52. This very passage is central to Nechas' discussion of how Melville uses *fix* (208), although he fails to note Melville's phonetic and lexical highlighting of the passage.

53. *Herman Melville* (New York: Harcourt Brace, 1929), 123 (also Hayford and Parker, 631). Note also Mumford's insistence (argued, unfortunately, in very subjective terms) on Melville's mastery of rhythm.